

Impact & Benefits Document

What ASTRA changes for candidates, exam authorities, centres and the public

Every cancelled exam avoided saves thousands of journeys, working days and hopes.

The cost of one cancelled exam shift

2,445

candidates at one failed computer-test centre (NEET-PG, Jaipur 2026)

≈ ₹3,100

per candidate to come back: travel ₹1,500 + stay ₹1,000 + a lost working day ₹600 (our estimate)

≈ ₹76 lakh

paid by candidates themselves, for one centre and one repeat trip

This doesn't include lost preparation time, stress, the cost of holding the exam again, or court cases. When digital result processing failed in Telangana in 2019, a wave of student suicides followed. The human cost is real.

Who benefits

Candidates

No answers or minutes lost. Fewer wasted trips. A message within 30 seconds. Equal treatment, a receipt for their answers, Hindi and English, and built-in support for extra time.

Exam authorities

Fewer re-exams and court cases. Decisions in minutes, backed by evidence. A live view of every centre. Vendors judged on clear, measurable records.

Centre staff

Clear step-by-step instructions, spare-PC procedures, and records that protect honest staff from being wrongly blamed.

Government and society

More trust in government digital services, less incentive to cheat, and data kept on local servers using free software.

Impact at a glance

Area	Impact
Social	Less stress for lakhs of young people; fewer wasted trips for rural families; results depend on merit, not on whether the power stayed on
Economic	Savings on travel, stay, lost wages and repeat exams; no software licence fees
Education	Admissions and academic calendars stay on time
Governance	Every action recorded, two-person approval, vendors measured
Candidate experience	Clear updates, predictable recovery, a receipt they can check

Madhya Pradesh MP

MPESB has faced every kind of digital failure:

- **2020–21:** three exams cancelled after question papers were downloaded from unauthorised computers.
- **May 2025:** an exam shift postponed after 4,818 candidates had already reached centres.
- **June 2026:** a server failure cancelled a shift after a 3-hour wait.

ASTRA can give MP a **model exam system** that other states can copy.

Supports national goals

Digital India

NEP 2020

Viksit Bharat 2047

Good Governance

Trust in digital public services

Public Examinations Act 2024

Data Protection Act 2023

How we'll measure success

What we measure	Today	Target with ASTRA
Answers lost after a failure	Not tracked; candidates often start again	0
Exam time lost during an outage	Guessed, inconsistent	0 minutes
Time until candidates are told	Up to hours	Under 30 seconds
Time to reach a decision	Hours to days	Minutes, with evidence
Candidates re-tested	Whole shift or centre	Only those affected
Same centre failing again	Not noticed	Flagged before the next exam